

Illustration: V.K.



## Reel Drama in Real Life

**MUMBAI** It was a week worthy of Bollywood—it had drama and a number of flip-flops as many of its films have. A few film personalities were first seen supporting and then quickly distancing themselves from Raj Thackeray's raging anti-migrant controversy. As people came to know that actors Salman Khan, Suneil Shetty and film-

maker Sajid Khan had extended support to Raj, thus, creating a divide in the industry, the three swiftly issued denials, clarifying that they were not against north Indians.

While director Sajid Khan claimed that he was against the gag order on the Maharashtra Navnirman Sena (MNS) chief, Salman Khan

**SLUGFEST:** Raj finds support in Bollywood explained "we being migrants ourselves are not in any position to support such claims. My father is a migrant from Madhya Pradesh and my mother is from Jammu." Says Shirish Parkar, spokesperson of MNS: "The controversy was just created by the media. Several noted personalities have spoken out against the gag order, and Nana Patekar has even openly stated the needs of the sons of the soil should be given preference."

The MNS letter against the gag order, which has got almost 10 lakh signatures, states: "In our democratic country, everybody has the freedom of movement but does no one have the freedom of speech about his/her state, language and culture?" With the issue settled, Bollywood is now applauding Raj's plans of setting up a Cine Workers' Association to improve working conditions in the industry.

by Aditi Pai

## SIGNPOSTS

**ARRESTED:** Arms dealer **Suresh Nanda** and his son **Sanjeev Nanda** for entering into a criminal conspiracy to suppress an income tax case against them. Nanda Sr allegedly received kick-backs worth Rs 1,150 crore in several defence deals including Barak Missiles.

**AWARDED:** Best-selling author **Pinkie Virani** with the National Stree Shakti Award for bravely talking in public of her own sexual abuse as a child in her book *Bitter Chocolate* and creating awareness about child sexual abuse.

**WON:** The Malaysian Open by golfer **Arjun Atwal**. He beat defending champion Peter Hedblom of Sweden. Atwal had last won the tournament in 2003.

**AWARDED:** Violin maestro **Lalgudi G. Jayaraman** with the Music Academy's Lifetime Achievement Award in recognition of his monumental contribution to Carnatic music.

**VIS-A-VIS** GURUDAS DASGUPTA CPI leader versus K.P.S. GILL Indian Hockey Federation chief

It is a matter of shame that we did not qualify for the Olympics. It is high time that Mr Gill is thrown out from his post.



SAURABH SINGH

We do not have an instant coffee machine that can give you results instantly. It takes time to regain your position.

**EPILOGUE:** Indian hockey is in a shambles, and one needs actions to save it, not verbal volleys.